Hartford Public Schools

Family & Community Engagement Office

Family Event Food Allergen Labeling Guidance

Effective October 2026

Any dish served at a school family or community event must be posted with an allergen card at the serving table. The card lists every major food allergen present in that dish. The major allergens are: milk, eggs, wheat, soy, peanuts, tree nuts, fish, and shellfish.

When a dish is prepared by an outside kitchen or vendor, the label the vendor submits is a starting point, not the final word. The staff member coordinating the event checks the submitted label against the food as actually prepared, using both the tray photograph and the kitchen's written ingredient information, before any card is posted or shared with families. An allergen is listed on the card if it appears in any source. Some allergens are not visible in a photograph and are found only in the kitchen's own description of the dish.

The card must reflect the food AS IT WILL BE SERVED. The most recent information from the kitchen governs; an ingredient the kitchen has removed is no longer listed, and an ingredient it has added must appear. A vendor's assurance that a dish is 'free' of an allergen does not replace this check.

If a submitted label is wrong or incomplete, hold the card. Do not post it and do not send it to families until it has been corrected and approved by the building administrator.

Questions: Family & Community Engagement Office, Hartford Public Schools.